

GIVING A NEW LIFE TO SMARTPHONES

IN CONVERSATION WITH **YUG BHATIA**,
FOUNDER AND CEO OF CONTROLZ ABOUT THE
REFURBISHED SMARTPHONE MARKET AND THE
ROLE OF CONTROLZ IN IT

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YUG BHATIA
Founder and CEO of ControlZ

Smartphones have become an essential commodity in our lives today. From being our primary communications and entertainment device, to becoming an extension of our body, giving us access to services and processing power that we would otherwise dream of a couple of decades ago, smartphones are indispensable in our lives today. However, with their increased capabilities, their prices have also shot up, and hence in the last few years, we have seen an increased demand for refurbished smartphones.

Q What budget category of smartphones is in demand the most?

A The most in-demand smartphone categories fall into two ranges: under 20K and around 40-45K. We believe this is largely due to a strong preference for budget-friendly premium devices in the under 20K range, as well as for higher-end ones retailing at more than 60K, with a notable demand for iPhones.

Q Can you shed some light on your refurbishment process and what makes it different?

A At ControlZ, we take pride in our meticulous component-level renewal process. Each phone goes through a rigorous disassembly, diagnosis, and renewal to ensure it looks and functions just like new. Our mission? To extend the lifecycle of smartphones and set a new standard in the industry.

While some competitors may offer basic refurbishment, our commitment to quality and sustainability sets us apart. Here's what makes our process unique:

Comprehensive Component-Level Repair: We focus on repairing individual components, retaining up to 80% of the original parts whenever possible. This minimizes waste and ensures your phone functions flawlessly.

Rigorous Quality Checks: After renewal, each device undergoes extensive testing to meet our high standards for appearance and functionality. You can be confident your "renewed" phone will perform just as well as a brand-new one.

Our commitment to quality and meticulous renewal process is what makes us the unrivalled leader in the smartphone renewal category.

Q Are there any myths around refurbished devices that are very prevalent in the Indian market?

A Yes, there are quite a few myths about refurbished devices in the Indian market. One big misconception is that refurbished smartphones are of lower quality or aren't as reliable as new ones. Many people think these devices are just "second-hand" and bound to have issues, but the truth is, refurbished smartphones go through thorough testing and quality checks to make sure they perform just like new.

Another myth is that refurbished devices don't come with warranties or after-sales support, which can make customers hesitant. At ControlZ, though, we offer up to 18 months of warranty and reliable customer service, giving customers the same peace of mind they'd get with a brand-new device.

Finally, some believe that refurbished devices are outdated or missing features. In reality, many refurbished gadgets are from recent models and